

Observe. Interpret. Then make.

Minecraft asks about creative freedom.
The Last of Us asks about expectation.

Time	Focus	Minutes
10:00–10:05	The spine: two worlds that exist twice	5
10:05–10:45	Minecraft: your choices, the film, the filmmakers	40
10:45–11:20	The Last of Us, season 1 episode 1: the cold open	35
11:20–11:30	Ten-minute break	10
11:30–12:45	Team board workshop: build, then check, then save	75
12:45–12:50	Exit ticket, two lines	5

Protect 11:35–12:30. The full workshop is 75 minutes. Its 55-minute build is uninterrupted. Cut discussion if late; move a creator excerpt to preparation if necessary.

Your opening • 10:00–10:05

“What should someone feel in your game, and what will they do that creates that feeling? Today we’ll examine two adaptations, then use what we notice to make our boards better.”

Introduce the three questions: what survived, what was reinvented, what is gone. Read the content note: mild fantasy peril; a pandemic discussion. Students may look away or step out.

The sequence: students make their own observations before hearing creator intent. Both scenes play once. No Minecraft game trailer. Creator excerpts total 3:15.

YOUR BOARD • 20–40 IMAGES

Thu Oct 1 • 5 PM Pacific

Save and submit the actual file to the course Drive.

TEAM PRESENTATIONS

Mon Oct 5 • 5 minutes

Everyone speaks. No new homework; the board is the work.

Minecraft: making choices.

The feeling of creative freedom, carried into a film.

10:05–10:08

Remember a choice

Ask two students: Think of something you built in Minecraft. What was one choice that made it yours? Take one concrete choice from each. If someone has not played, let them use a partner's example. No game trailer.

■ Your example is our game evidence. We are asking whether the film carries the feeling of making a choice.

10:08–10:12

Watch the film once

Play Steve's prologue from My name is Steve; stop before the Nether, or at four minutes, whichever comes first. If it ends early, use the remaining time for silent notes.

■ Watch who makes the choices, and notice one moment that gives you a feeling.

10:12–10:15

Write before discussion

Give one silent minute to name a remembered player choice and one observed film moment; then two minutes to compare in pairs. Label memory and observation separately.

■ I chose ___ in the game. The film chooses ___ for me. That makes me feel ___.

10:15–10:20

Hear the room first

Take two or three accounts. Ask for the specific moment behind each opinion. A still frame is optional; do not replay the whole scene.

■ Which feeling of Minecraft came across? Which did not? Different answers are useful if you can explain them.

10:20–10:22

Hear the filmmakers

Open Exclusive insights from A MINECRAFT MOVIE at 1:28. Stop at 2:29: 61 seconds. Use the remainder for the transition. This is promotional material expressing intent, not independent proof of success.

■ They describe modding, the first night, physical design and community input. What were they trying to preserve?

10:22–10:30

Test intent against experience

In teams for four minutes, connect one filmmaker claim to one moment from the prologue or the team's game experience. Hear two responses for four minutes. Do not pretend that the prologue shows every event discussed in the featurette.

■ Where does your evidence support their intention? What would you need to see to judge the rest?

10:30–10:40

Turn the question into a board decision

Teams open their actual board. Name a feeling and the player action meant to create it. Identify one reference to add, replace or test. Spend seven minutes working and three comparing the decision with a nearby team.

■ Our player feels ___ because they ___. Which image helps us make that happen?

10:40–10:45

Close the loop

Take two brief decisions. Summarize: an adaptation can preserve a feeling while changing how it is produced. A board should guide the experience, not only identify the setting. Move to The Last of Us at 10:45.

■ Your board needs to explain the experience you want someone to have.

The Last of Us: expectation.

One warning changes how we anticipate ordinary life.

10:45–10:49

Watch the cold open once

Play The Last of Us S1E1: the 1968 talk show to the title card, up to four minutes. If it ends early, begin silent notes. No full replay.

What does this scene make you expect from the ordinary world that follows?

10:49–10:53

Form your own reading

One minute of silent notes, two minutes in pairs, one response. Require a detail of dialogue, framing or sound. The family scenes are a prediction exercise; they are not screened today.

What made you uneasy? Point to the detail that did it.

10:53–10:58

Compare only what you know

Invite a specific remembered game-opening moment. Label it as recall. If nobody has one, stay with the TV scene and list a comparison question to test later. The IGN comparison is optional preparation, not assigned classroom playback.

What information reached you, and when? Did you discover it through an action, a scene, or dialogue?

10:58–11:01

Hear the creators

Play HBO/Max's episode-one podcast from 8:38 to 10:52: 2 minutes 14 seconds. Stop there. Use the remaining 46 seconds to return to the room. Audio discussion: enable captions and test sound at preflight.

Listen for why they changed the opening, and what they wanted the next scenes to feel like.

11:01–11:08

Connect choice and effect

Teams connect the creators' explanation to one observed detail for three minutes; compare two responses for four minutes. Distinguish their intended effect from each student's actual response.

The opening gives us ___, so even an ordinary breakfast might feel ___. What in the scene earns that prediction?

11:08–11:17

Try it on your own world

For six minutes, choose one board reference that controls what a player notices or learns. For three minutes, explain to another team how light, composition or contrast would guide attention. A game can also use framing and dialogue.

What should your player notice first? What should remain uncertain? Show us the reference that helps you decide.

11:17–11:20

Make the transfer explicit

Each team records one candidate board change. Protect the full break and the workshop clock.

Minecraft asks how to carry creative freedom across media. The Last of Us asks how to shape expectation. Your board should help someone make those choices.

The room becomes a studio.

11:20–11:30: full ten-minute break. Alex closes playback and opens the workshop.

11:30–11:35

01 / Choose

Name one highest-priority change.

11:35–12:30

02 / Build

55 protected minutes in your real shared board. Professor circulates.

12:30–12:40

03 / Check

Partner team or your own team. Use the four rubric criteria.

12:40–12:45

04 / Save

Revise. Save the actual file. Record tonight's one action.

During the 55-minute sprint: circulate. Ask what decision each reference supports. Let teams add, replace, cut or test. Keep everyone in their real shared file.

At 12:30: four lenses

Cohesion: one aesthetic direction. **Curation:** every image earns its place. **Palette:** test on a screen.

Presentation: a stranger can read and navigate it. Partner-team or within-team check; no full-class critique rotation.

At 12:45: two lines

One term and where it appeared. One uncertainty. End at 12:50. Use the common confusion to open the next session.

When the room changes the plan

- **Running late:** take time from discussion or move the creator explanation to preparation. Preserve the break and 11:35–12:30 sprint.
- **HBO Max fails:** troubleshoot for one minute. Minecraft: use the official Warner Bros. preview at 1:20–5:02, instead of the streaming scene. The Last of Us: label the talk-show synopsis as a description; do not claim the room observed it.
- **YouTube fails:** paraphrase the intended choice in one sentence and return to student evidence. Media cues include the idea to convey.
- **No sound:** use captions where available; do not judge unheard music or vocal performance.
- **No network:** use the printed prompts and paper sketches; label recalled or described examples accurately. Save the plan for later transfer into the shared board.
- **A strong board:** test palette and legibility. More images are optional.

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TEAM PRESENTATIONS

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Everyone speaks. No new homework; the board is the work.

Ready before 10.

9:45 classroom check

Alex tests display, sound and captions. Sign in to HBO Max. Cue Steve's prologue and the 1968 talk show by landmarks; play ten seconds and reset. Cue both YouTube excerpts, allow ads to finish, pause at the starts, and note their manual stops. Confirm each team can open its real shared board.

HBO Max signed-in playback remains unobserved in this preparation. YouTube excerpt selection is based on player displays and transcripts; check playback on the classroom machine.

Four viewing cues

At	Source	Stop
10:08–10:12	A Minecraft Movie: Steve's prologue	Before Nether; 4:00 cap
10:20–10:22	Exclusive insights from A MINECRAFT MOVIE	2:29
10:45–10:49	The Last of Us S1E1: the 1968 cold open	Title card; 4:00 cap
10:58–11:01	The Last of Us Podcast: Episode 1	10:52

Optional preparation · not assigned playback

[The Minecraft Movie: What Happened? \(A Retrospective\)](#) — Joseph Fisher · 34:29 · focus 6:20–7:10

Instructor preparation: critical argument about imaginative freedom versus the film setting. Opinion, with profanity elsewhere in the full essay. Not assigned playback.

[The Last of Us Episode 1: TV Show vs Game Comparison](#) — IGN · 4:22

Optional preparation: side-by-side scenes, episode-one spoilers. Useful for framing and performance; cinematics alone do not demonstrate player control. Not assigned playback.

Keep the distinctions clear

Memory: a student's specific recalled choice. **Observation:** a moment the room actually saw. **Intent:** what a creator says they aimed to do. **Effect:** what the student experienced. Agreement between intent and effect is a question, not an assumption.

After class: record what ran, which scenes played, and the common exit-ticket confusion in the course record. No new homework; the existing board is due October 1.